

Mercy

After the example of God.

Luke 6:36. Be ye therefore merciful, as your Father also is merciful.

Enjoined.

2 Kings 6:21-23. And the king of Israel said unto Elisha, when he saw them, My Father, shall I smite them? shall I smite them? And he answered, Thou shalt not smite them: wouldest thou smite those whom thou hast taken captive with thy sword and with thy bow? set bread and water before them, that they may eat and drink, and go to their master. And he prepared great provision for them: and when they had eaten and drunk, he sent them away, and they went to their master. So the bands of Syria came no more into the land of Israel.

Hosea 12:6. Therefore turn thou to thy God: keep mercy and Judgment, and wait on thy God continually.

Romans 12:20-21. Therefore if thine enemy hunger, feed him; if he thirst, give him drink: for in so doing thou shalt heap coals of fire on his head. Be not overcome of evil, but overcome evil with good.

To be engraved on the heart.

Proverbs 3:3. Let not mercy and truth forsake thee: bind them about thy neck; write them upon the table of thine heart:

Characteristic of Saints.

Psalms 37:26. He is ever merciful, and lendeth; and his seed is blessed.

Isaiah 57:1. The Righteous perisheth, and no man layeth it to heart: and merciful men are taken away, none considering that the Righteous is taken away from the evil to come.

SHOULD BE SHOWN

With cheerfulness.

Romans 12:8. Or he that exhorteth, on exhortation: he that giveth, let him do it with simplicity; he that ruleth, with diligence; he that sheweth mercy, with cheerfulness.

To our Brethren.

Zechariah 7:9. Thus speaketh the LORD of hosts, saying, Execute true Judgment, and shew mercy and compassions every man to his brother:

To those that are in distress.

Luke 10:37. And he said, He that shewed mercy on him. Then said Jesus unto him, Go, and do thou likewise.

To the poor.

Proverbs 14:31. He that oppresseth the poor reproacheth his Maker: but he that honoureth him hath mercy on the poor.

Daniel 4:27. Wherefore, O king, let my counsel be acceptable unto thee, and break off thy Sins by righteousness, and thine iniquities by shewing mercy to the poor; if it may be a lengthening of thy tranquillity.

To backsliders.

Luke 15:18-20. I will arise and go to my Father, and will say unto him, Father, I have Sinned against heaven, and before thee, And am no more worthy to be called thy son: make me as one of thy hired servants. And he arose, and came to his Father. But when he was yet a great way off, his Father saw him, and had compassion, and ran, and fell on his neck, and kissed him.

2 Corinthians 2:6-8. Sufficient to such a man is this punishment, which was inflicted of many. So that contrariwise ye ought rather to forgive him, and comfort him, lest perhaps such a one should be swallowed up with overmuch sorrow. Wherefore I Beseech you that ye would confirm your love toward him.

To animals.

Proverbs 12:10. A Righteous man regardeth the life of his beast: but the tender mercies of the wicked are cruel.

Upholds the throne of kings.

Proverbs 20:28. Mercy and truth preserve the king: and his throne is upholden by mercy.

Beneficial to those who exercise.

Proverbs 11:17. The merciful man doeth good to his own soul: but he that is cruel troubleth his own flesh.

Blessedness of showing.

Proverbs 14:21. He that despiseth his neighbour Sinneth: but he that hath mercy on the poor, happy is he.

Matthew 5:7. Blessed are the Merciful: for they shall obtain mercy.

Hypocrites devoid of.

Matthew 23:23. Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye pay tithe of mint and Anise and Cummin, and have omitted the weightier matters of The Law, Judgment, mercy, and Faith: these ought ye to have done, and not to leave the other undone.

Denunciations against those devoid of.

Hosea 4:1. Hear the word of the LORD, ye children of Israel: for the LORD hath a controversy with the inhabitants of the land, because there is no truth, nor mercy, nor knowledge of God in the land.

Hosea 4:3. Therefore shall the land mourn, and every one that dwelleth therein shall languish, with the beasts of the field, and with the fowls of heaven; yea, the fishes of the sea also shall be taken away.